SOC-03 | Therapist only - all age groups

Requests, refusals and negotiation

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Phrase a need, request or refusal and explore what is negotiable and what is a boundary. The aim is clear, respectful expression with choice, not securing agreement at any cost.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

A personal refusal does not require explanation or an alternative. Consent is voluntary and can change; do not practice pressure, manipulation or compromising safety. Power differences may require support or another channel.

Reusing existing material

SOC-01 introduces a request and boundary. Here we distinguish the need, wording, flexible part and non-negotiable boundary, and prepare a possible response to refusal.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Lior is asked to help at the weekend. She chooses to say she is unavailable on Saturday, and considers offering another day only if it suits her.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What am I asking for or declining, and in what context?

2 | Question for discussion

How will I express the need specifically?

3 | Question for discussion

Which details are flexible, and which boundaries remain?

4 | Question for discussion

What will I do if agreement is not possible?

5 | Question for discussion

Is another coordination channel or support person needed?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If the person fears a response, explore whether that fear reflects actual risk. An indirect channel or no conversation may be chosen. Do not treat another person's refusal as a failure of wording.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

Choose an everyday request that does not put the child at risk. The adult is responsible for protection from pressure; saying no does not depend on perfect politeness.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Address peer pressure and power differences without requiring disclosure of a sensitive event. Wording can be practiced only in the session.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Explore professional duties and coordination arrangements separately from personal boundaries. Do not promise that assertive wording removes power differences or guarantees agreement.

OA | Older adults

Allow requests for help, refusal of help and changing preferences. A chosen companion may help communicate, but does not replace the participant's wishes.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Choose a small request or practice a fictional dialogue with the therapist. Do not try refusing a threatening person; arranging safety and support comes before practicing wording.

At the next session

Explore whether the message reflected the need and boundary and preserved choice. Stopping or seeking support may be appropriate, even without negotiation.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.cci.health.wa.gov.au/Resources/Looking-After-Yourself/Assertiveness

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